

Figure 5.7: Flame colours of alkaline earth metal salts

5.5.2 Distinctive behavior of beryllium

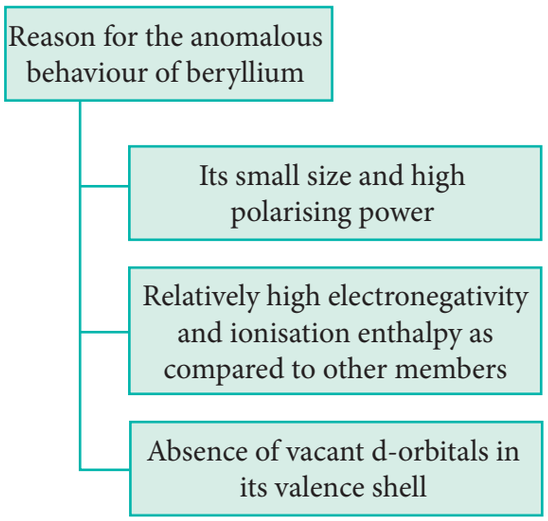


Figure 5.8 Distinctive behaviour of beryllium

The anomalous properties of beryllium is mainly due to its small size, high electronegativity, high ionisation energy and high polarising power compared to the other elements in the block. The anomalous properties of beryllium compared to other elements of the group are mentioned in Table 5.11

Table 5.11 Comparison of Properties of Beryllium with other elements of the group

Beryllium	Other elements of the family
Forms covalent compounds	form ionic compounds
High melting and boiling point	Low melting and boiling point
Does not react with water even at elevated temperature	React with water
Does not combine directly with hydrogen	Combine directly with hydrogen
Does not combine directly with halogens. Halides are covalent.	Combine directly with halogens Halides are electrovalent.

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